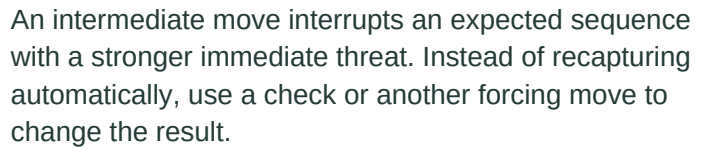


Intermediate moves

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

Previous move: 12.Qxg6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

12...Bxc4+ 13. Kg1 fxg6

12...Bxc4+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **13.Kg1**.

13...fxg6 The pawn captures the queen on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +12. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +12:** the balance goes from -8 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.